

RUSTSCAN MASTERY GUIDE (Advanced + Practical)

SECTION 1: CORE CONCEPT

RustScan is a high-speed TCP port scanner written in Rust. It solves the slowness of traditional scanners.

SECTION 2: ALL CORE COMMANDS

`rustscan -a <target>`
→ Scan default top ports
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10`

Expected Output:
[~] Open ports: 22, 80

`rustscan -a <target> -p <ports>`
→ Specify ports
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 -p 22,80,443`

`rustscan -a <target> -r <range>`
→ Scan range
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 -r 1-65535`

`rustscan -a <target> --ulimit <num>`
→ Increase performance
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 --ulimit 5000`

`rustscan -a <target> --timeout <ms>`
→ Set timeout
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 --timeout 2000`

`rustscan -a <target> --batch-size <num>`
→ Control number of ports scanned at once
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 --batch-size 1000`

`rustscan -a <target> -- -sV`
→ Pass arguments to Nmap
Example:
`rustscan -a 10.10.10.10 -- -sV -sC`

Expected Output:

PORT	STATE	SERVICE	VERSION
22/tcp	open	ssh	OpenSSH 8.2
80/tcp	open	http	Apache

SECTION 3: OUTPUT INTERPRETATION

RustScan output:

→ Fast port discovery

Nmap output:

→ Service detection

→ Versioning

→ Scripts

SECTION 4: EXTREME USAGE (REAL WORLD)

1. FULL RECON PIPELINE:

```
rustscan -a <target> -r 1-65535 -- -sV -sC -A
```

2. CTF SPEED RUN:

```
rustscan -a <target> --ulimit 5000 -- -sV
```

3. STEALTHIER APPROACH:

Lower batch size:

```
--batch-size 200
```

4. SCRIPTING PIPELINE:

```
ports=$(rustscan -a target | grep Open | cut ...)
```

```
nmap -p $ports target
```

SECTION 5: EDGE CASES

- Firewalled hosts → use slower batch
- VPS scanning → increase ulimit
- Detection evasion → combine with proxychains

SECTION 6: COMPARISON WITH NMAP

RustScan:

✓ Fast discovery

✗ No deep scanning

Nmap:

✓ Deep analysis

✗ Slower

Best practice: Use BOTH

SECTION 7: PRO TIPS

- Always scan ALL ports first
- Never trust default scans
- Automate workflows
- Combine with:
ffuf, gobuster, nikto

SECTION 8: FINAL WORKFLOW (HTB STYLE)

1. rustscan full scan
2. nmap detailed scan
3. service enumeration
4. exploit development

This guide is optimized for penetration testers, CTF players, and security engineers.